COX SOLAR SOLUTIONS
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ILLINOIS HOMEOWNER GUIDE

Cox Solar Solutions

You provide the roof and only pay for the power your system produces. We take care of everything else.

Roof-ready solar for Illinois homes. Your Roof, Our Legacy.

What we do

Cox inspects or replaces the roof, then designs a solar system for that deck. Design, permits, installation, utility interconnection, and monitoring stay with us. You keep a dry home and a production number you can see on your bill.

Why homeowners go solar

Lower the electric bill

A rooftop system makes power where you use it. Surplus energy can go back to the utility so you earn bill credits instead of buying every kilowatt-hour at retail.

Lock in more predictable energy costs

Utility rates move. Solar that you host on your roof turns unused sun into a hedge against rising supply charges over the life of the system.

Protect the roof and the investment together

Cox starts with the roof. If shingles, flashing, or decking need work, we address that before panels go up so the array sits on a sound, warrantied surface.

Stack Illinois programs while they last

ComEd smart-inverter rebates, Solar for All for income-eligible homes, a 20-year property-tax hold-harmless, and Chicago permit fast-tracks can all change the numbers. We check what this address can actually claim.

How solar works

Solar panels

Modules on the south- and west-facing planes collect sunlight and convert it into direct current (DC) electricity.

Inverter

A smart, grid-interactive inverter turns DC into household AC and talks to the utility so the system can qualify for Illinois distributed-generation rebates.

Your home first

Power flows to lights, HVAC, and appliances in real time. You use what you generate before you buy from the grid.

Credits for surplus

Extra production exports to the grid. Illinois credits that export — full retail-rate credits for legacy systems, or supply-only credits under Smart Solar Billing for new interconnects.

Net energy metering

Production you do not use is sent to the grid. The utility credits surplus energy on a 12-month cycle. Legacy Illinois systems (installed before January 1, 2025) generally receive full retail-rate credits. New systems receive supply-only credits under Smart Solar Billing.



Illinois & Chicago programs

PROGRAM	WHAT IT CAN MEAN FOR THIS HOUSE
Illinois Solar for All (ILSFA) REBATE	Income-eligible households (at or below 80% of area median income) can receive no-upfront-cost solar that is designed to deliver at least 50% savings on the value of energy produced. Availability and approved-vendor rules apply.

PROGRAM	WHAT IT CAN MEAN FOR THIS HOUSE
ComEd Distributed Generation Smart Inverter Rebate — Solar REBATE	ComEd customers can receive a $300-per-kW upfront rebate for a solar system equipped with a qualifying smart inverter. Typical 7 kW home: about $2,100 before other programs.
ComEd Distributed Generation Smart Inverter Rebate — Battery REBATE	ComEd customers can receive a $300-per-kWh cash rebate for a battery with a smart inverter. Enrollment in a qualifying rate plan is required. Newer storage rebates generally include virtual-power-plant participation.
Virtual Power Plant (VPP) — Battery Storage Rebate REBATE	Under the CRGA-mandated Virtual Power Plant program (utility launch targeted by mid-2026), residential battery customers can earn the $300/kWh distributed-generation rebate by allowing the utility to dispatch the battery during high-demand events.
Illinois Net Metering / Smart Solar Billing NET METERING	Illinois still offers net metering. Legacy customers (systems installed before January 1, 2025) receive full retail-rate credits. New customers receive supply-only credits under Smart Solar Billing. We model both so the savings story matches the interconnect date.
Illinois Solar Property Tax Exemption PROPERTY TAX EXEMPTION	Illinois law excludes the added home value from a solar installation from property-tax assessments for 20 years (typically claimed with Form PTAX-330), so going solar should not raise the assessed value of the array itself.
City of Chicago Solar Express Permit Program PERMIT SAVINGS	Chicago homeowners installing solar can use an expedited permitting path with a flat $100 savings on permit fees through Solar Express when the project qualifies.
City of Chicago Green Permit Program PERMIT SAVINGS	Qualifying Chicago solar installations can receive priority permit review and reduced permit fees through the City of Chicago Green Permit Program.

How a Cox install moves

1. Roof and bill review

We measure the roof, check remaining life, and review 12 months of electric usage so the system is sized to the home — not a guess.

2. Design and incentives

You get a layout, production estimate, and a written list of programs this property may qualify for (utility rebate, Solar for All, Chicago permits, tax form).

3. Permits and interconnection

Cox files the building permit and the utility interconnection. Chicago jobs can use Solar Express or Green Permit when the project qualifies.

4. Install, inspect, turn on

Crews set racking and modules, the electrician lands the inverter, the city and utility inspect, and monitoring goes live after permission to operate.

Questions we hear on the porch

Do I have to buy the system outright?

Not always. Many homeowners host the system on their roof and pay for the kilowatt-hours it produces. Cash, loan, and income-qualified Solar for All paths are reviewed against the same roof and bill so you can compare apples to apples.

What if my roof is old?

We inspect first. If the roof has limited life left, Cox can replace or repair it before solar goes on. Panels should not be the thing that forces a reroof five years later.

Did Illinois kill net metering?

No. Systems that interconnected before January 1, 2025 generally keep full retail-rate credits. New systems use Smart Solar Billing (supply-only export credits). Rebates and the property-tax exemption still matter on the new tariff — we run the numbers on your usage, not a national average.

What about the federal tax credit?

The residential federal credit changed after 2025. Whether a cash purchase, loan, lease, or power-purchase agreement still captures any remaining federal value depends on the offer and the placed-in-service rules. We will tell you what applies to the option in front of you instead of promising a credit that may not be there.

How much maintenance is there?

Rain does most of the washing. We recommend a visual check after major storms and keeping monitoring alerts on. Inverters and batteries have their own warranties; we walk those terms at proposal time.

Will solar raise my property taxes?

Illinois excludes the added value of a qualifying solar energy system from assessment for 20 years when the exemption is filed. You still own a more valuable home — you should not be taxed as if the county added the array to the land value.

Ready for a roof-first solar review?

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Educational marketing only — not a quote, contract, tax opinion, or guarantee of savings. Incentive amounts, tariffs, income limits, interconnect rules, and permit fees change. Eligibility depends on utility territory, install date, system design, income, and program capacity. Confirm current ComEd, Ameren, Illinois Solar for All, Illinois Shines, and City of Chicago terms before you sign.